NICOLE RUSH | *Creative Director • Senior Graphic Designer • Brand Designer*

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CREATIVE PROFILE

Brand-focused creative professional with 18+ years in graphic design, art direction, and creative leadership. Builds cohesive visual identities and brand systems across print, digital, and web, translating strategy into compelling design. Combines strong Adobe Creative Suite and Figma craft with experience directing creative teams and managing brand standards from concept through production.

SKILLS & TOOLS

Design & Brand: Brand Identity & Visual Systems, Art Direction, Typography & Layout, Print & Digital Design, Packaging & Collateral Design, Presentation Design, Web & UI Design

Creative Leadership: Creative Direction, Design Team Leadership & Mentoring, Client & Stakeholder Presentations, Production Management, Brand Standards & Guidelines

Tools: Adobe Creative Cloud (Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign, After Effects), Figma, Canva, WordPress, HTML/CSS

EXPERIENCE

Brilliancy Quantum | Lawrence, KS — May 2026 – Present

Creative Director

- Built brand identity and visual systems for the parent company and Brilliancy Health, a new division — logo, color palette, typography, and brand guidelines — establishing a cohesive presence across both brands.
- Designed a multi-page product website spanning nearly a dozen sub-brand product lines, including custom UI mockups, hero treatments, and product diagrams for each.
- Led creative direction for the Brilliancy Health Summit 2026, including the event landing page, invitations, save-the-dates, and a full media and brand kit for press and partners.
- Designed pitch decks and proposals used in business development and stakeholder communications and partnered with founders to translate business strategy into visual brand direction.

JNT Company | Manhattan, KS — May 2025 – May 2026

Creative Director (promoted from Graphic Designer)

- Promoted from Graphic Designer to Creative Director within six months in recognition of design skill, creative leadership, and consistent quality of output.
- Directed and produced multi-channel creative — web, digital, social, and print — for a diverse client portfolio, maintaining brand consistency, quality, and deadlines across concurrent projects.
- Designed and art directed campaign assets that grew client social presence by 129% and nearly quadrupled monthly profile views within three months.
- Developed client-facing design presentations and creative recommendations that strengthened relationships and supported continued business.
- Built and implemented production workflows that improved design team efficiency and turnaround time.

The Alms Group | Manhattan, KS — Apr 2022 – Mar 2025

Director of Marketing and Philanthropy (promoted from Graphic Designer)

- Designed and art directed brand, digital, and print materials for organizational communications and fundraising campaigns, maintaining consistent brand standards across all channels.
- Led creative direction for multi-channel campaigns — email, web, social, event, and print — that increased audience participation by 35%.
- Redesigned email creative and messaging that lifted open rates by 33% and click-through rates by 78%.
- Promoted from Graphic Designer to Director of Marketing based on design leadership and creative contributions.

Graphic Designer | Apr 2021 – Apr 2022

- Designed digital, print, and web assets for organizational communications and fundraising campaigns while maintaining brand standards.

AIB International Inc. | Manhattan, KS — Aug 2006 – Apr 2020

Marketing Specialist & Graphic Designer

- Designed print, digital, and e-learning visual materials for a global food safety organization, supporting training programs used across multiple countries.
- Produced high-volume brand collateral — brochures, trade show materials, newsletters, and digital assets — while improving production workflows and translating complex technical content into clear, accessible visual design.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts — Kansas State University